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Verbal Ability

GATE ECE General Aptitude · Previous Year Questions with Answer Key

53	14	2010 – 2026	English
QUESTIONS	PAPERS COVERED	YEARS	LANGUAGE

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Marks 1	37 questions
Marks 2	16 questions
Answer key	at the end

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Marks 1 37 questions

Q1. GATE ECE 2026

Among the following options, the antonym of the word 'nocturnal' is ____ .

(A) normal (B) diurnal (C) abnormal (D) exceptional

Open solution

Q2. GATE ECE 2025

Here are two analogous groups, Group-I and Group-II, that list words in their decreasing order of intensity. Identify the missing word in Group-II.

Group-I: Abuse → Insult → Ridicule

Group-II: _____→ Praise → Appreciate

(A) Extol (B) Prize (C) Appropriate (D) Espouse

Open solution

Q3. GATE ECE 2025

Had I learnt acting as a child, I_____a famous film star. Select the most appropriate option to complete the above sentence.

(A) will be (B) can be (C) am going to be (D) could have been

Open solution

Q4. GATE ECE 2024

If '→' denotes increasing order of intensity, then the meaning of the words [charm → enamor → bewitch] is analogous to [bored → _____ → weary]. Which one of the given options is appropriate to fill the blank?

(A) jaded (B) baffled (C) dead (D) worsted

Open solution

Q5. GATE ECE 2023

"I cannot support this proposal. My _____ will not permit it."

(A) conscious (B) consensus (C) conscience (D) consent

Open solution

Q6. GATE ECE 2023

Courts : _____ : : Parliament : Legislature

(By word meaning)

(A) Judiciary (B) Executive (C) Governmental (D) Legal

Open solution

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Q7. GATE ECE 2022

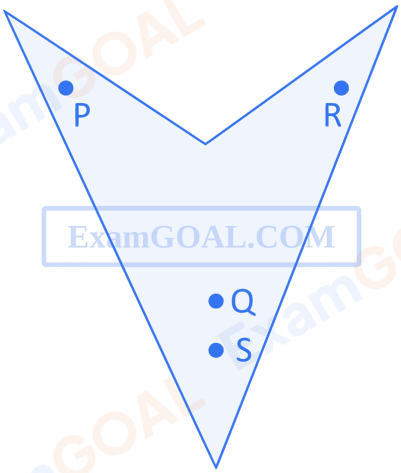
Mr. X speaks _____ Japanese _____ Chinese.

(A) neither / or (B) either / nor (C) neither / nor (D) also / but

Open solution

Q8. GATE ECE 2022

An art gallery engages a security guard to ensure that the items displayed are protected. The diagram below represents the plan of the gallery where the boundary walls are opaque. The location the security guard posted is identified such that all the inner space (shaded region in the plan) of the gallery is within the line of sight of the security guard. If the security guard does not move around the posted location and has a 360° view, which one of the following correctly represents the set of ALL possible locations among the locations P, Q, R, and S, where the security guard can be posted to watch over the entire inner space of the gallery.



(A) P and Q (B) Q (C) Q and S (D) R and S

Open solution

Q9. GATE ECE 2022

In a class of five students P, Q, R, S and T, only one student is known to have copied in the exam. The disciplinary committee has investigated the situation and recorded the statements from the students as given below.

Statement of P : R has copied in the exam.

Statement of Q : S has copied in the exam.

Statement of R : P did not copy in this exam.

Statement of S : Only one of us is telling the truth.

Statement of T : R is telling the truth.

The investigating team had authentic information that S never lies. Based on the information given above, the person who has copied in the exam is

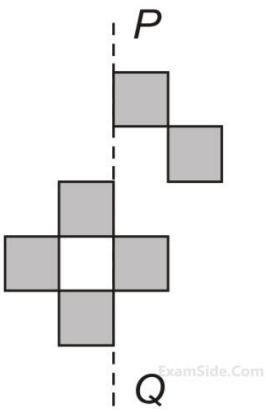
(A) R (B) P (C) Q (D) T

Open solution

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Q10. GATE ECE 2021

Open solution



The least number of squares that must be added so that the line P-Q becomes the line of symmetry is _____

(A) 7 (B) 6 (C) 4 (D) 3

Q11. GATE ECE 2021

Open solution

Nostalgia is to anticipation as _____ is to _____.

Which one of the following options maintains a similar logical relation in the above sentence?

(A) Past, future (B) Future, past (C) Future, present (D) Present, past

Q12. GATE ECE 2021

Open solution

Consider the following sentences :

(i) I woke up from sleep.

(ii) I woked up from sleep

(iii) I was woken up from sleep

(iv) I was wokened up from sleep.

Which of the above sentences are grammatically correct?

(A) (i) and (iv) (B) (i) and (ii) (C) (i) and (iii) (D) (ii) and (iii)

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Q13. GATE ECE 2020

He was not only accused of theft ____ of conspiracy.

(A) but also (B) but even (C) rather (D) rather than

Open solution

Q14. GATE ECE 2020

The Canadian constitution requires that equal importance be given to English and French. Last year, Air Canada lost a lawsuit and had to pay a six-figure fine to a French speaking couple after they filed complaints about formal in-flight announcements in English lasting 15 seconds, as opposed to informal 5 second messages in French.

The French - speaking couple were upset at ____ .

(A) the English announcements being longer than French ones.

(B) equal importance being given to English and French.

(C) the English announcements being clearer than the French ones.

(D) the in-flight announcements being made in English.

Open solution

Q15. GATE ECE 2020

Select the word that fits the analogy :

Explicit : Implicit : : Express : ____ .

(A) Repress (B) Suppress (C) Compress (D) Impress

Open solution

Q16. GATE ECE 2020

The untimely loss of life is a cause of serious global concern as thousands of people get killed ____ accidents every year while many other die ____ diseases like cardio vascular diseases, cancer, etc.

(A) in, of (B) during, from (C) from, of (D) from, from

Open solution

Q17. GATE ECE 2019

The strategies that the company _____ to sell its products _____ house-to-house marketing.

(A) use, includes (B) uses, including (C) uses, include (D) used, includes

Open solution

Q18. GATE ECE 2019

The boat arrived _____ dawn.

(A) on (B) in (C) at (D) under

Open solution

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Q19. GATE ECE 2019

When he did not come home, she ___ him lying dead on the roadside somewhere.

(A) notice (B) looked (C) concluded (D) pictured

Open solution

Q20. GATE ECE 2018

"Even though there is a vast scope for its _____, tourism has remained a/an _____ area."

The words that best fill the blanks in the above sentence are

(A) Improvement, neglected (B) Rejection, approved
(C) Fame, glum (D) Interest, disinterested

Open solution

Q21. GATE ECE 2018

"By giving him the last _____ of the cake, you will ensure lasting _____ in our house today."

The words that best fill the blanks in the above sentence are

(A) piece, peace (B) peace , piece (C) peace, peas (D) peas, piece

Open solution

Q22. GATE ECE 2017 Set 2

The ninth and the tenth of this month are Monday and Tuesday _____.

(A) Figuratively (B) Retrospectively (C) Respectively (D) Rightfully

Open solution

Q23. GATE ECE 2017 Set 2

It is ____ to read this year's textbook _____ the last year's.

(A) easier, than (B) most easy, than (C) easier, from (D) easiest, from

Open solution

Q24. GATE ECE 2017 Set 1

I _____ made arrangements had I _____informed earlier.

(A) could have, been (B) would have, being
(C) had, have (D) had been, been

Open solution

Q25. GATE ECE 2017 Set 1

She has a sharp tongue and it can occasionally turn

(A) hurtful (B) left (C) methodical (D) vital

Open solution

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Q26. GATE ECE 2012

Choose the most appropriate alternative from the options given below to complete the following sentence:

If the tired soldier wanted to lie down, he _____ the mattress out on the balcony.

(A) should take
(B) shall take
(C) should have taken
(D) will have taken

Open solution

Q27. GATE ECE 2012

Choose the most appropriate word from the options given below to complete the following sentence:

Given the seriousness of the situation that he had to face, his _____ was impressive.

(A) beggary
(B) nomenclature
(C) jealousy
(D) nonchalance

Open solution

Q28. GATE ECE 2012

Which one of the following options is the closest in meaning to the word given below?

Latitude

(A) Eligibility
(B) Freedom
(C) Coercion
(D) Meticulousness

Open solution

Q29. GATE ECE 2012

One of the parts (A, B, C, D) in the sentence given below contains an ERROR. Which one of the following is INCORRECT?

I requested that he should be given the driving test today instead of tomorrow.

(A) requested that
(B) should be given
(C) the driving test
(D) instead of tomorrow

Open solution

Q30. GATE ECE 2011

Choose the most appropriate word from the options given below to complete the following sentence:

It was her view that the country's problems had been_____ by foreign technocrats, so that to invite them to come back would be counter-productive.

(A) Identified
(B) ascertained
(C) exacerbated
(D) analyzed

Open solution

Q31. GATE ECE 2011

Choose the word from the options given below that is most nearly opposite in meaning to the given word:

Frequency

(A) periodicity
(B) rarity
(C) gradualness
(D) persistency

Open solution

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Q32. GATE ECE 2011

Choose the most appropriate word from the options given below to complete the following sentence:

Under ethical guidelines recently adopted by the Indian Medical Association, human genes are to be manipulated only to correct diseases for which _____ treatments are unsatisfactory.

(A) Similar (B) Most (C) Uncommon (D) Available

Open solution

Q33. GATE ECE 2011

The question below consists of a pair of related words followed by four pairs of words. Select the pair that best expresses the relation in the original pair:

Gladiator : Arena

(A) dancer : stage (B) commuter: train

(C) teacher : classroom (D) lawyer : courtroom

Open solution

Q34. GATE ECE 2010

Which of the following options is the closest in meaning to the world below:

Circuitous

(A) cyclic (B) indirect (C) confusing (D) crooked

Open solution

Q35. GATE ECE 2010

The question below consists of a pair of related of related words followed by four pairs of words. Select the pair that best expresses the relation in the original pair.

Unemployed : Worker

(A) fallow : land (B) unaware : sleeper

(C) wit : jester (D) renovated : house

Open solution

Q36. GATE ECE 2010

Choose the most appropriate word from the options given below to complete the following sentence:

If we manage to _____ our natural resources, we would leave a better planet for our children.

(A) uphold (B) restrain (C) cherish (D) conserve

Open solution

Q37. GATE ECE 2010

Choose the most appropriate word from the options given below to complete the following sentence:

His rather casual remarks on politics _____ his lack of seriousness about the subject.

(A) masked (B) belied (C) betrayed (D) suppressed

Open solution

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Marks 2 16 questions

Q38. GATE ECE 2026

Open solution

Each one of the following clues contains a keyword that is partially filled.

Clue 1: Synonym of recognize (8 letters): _ D _ NT_ FY

Clue 2: A story long enough to fill a book (5 letters): ____

Clue 3: Two of something (6 letters): ____ PLE

Clue 4: A fraction of something, split equally into two parts (4 letters): ____ F

The first letter of each of the keywords can be rearranged to form a four-letter word. Which one of the options below is a possible choice for the four-letter word?

(A) CHIN (B) COIN (C) ITCH (D) NOSE

Q39. GATE ECE 2025

Open solution

Identify the option that has the most appropriate sequence such that a coherent paragraph is formed:

P. Over time, such adaptations lead to significant evolutionary changes with the potential to shape the development of new species.

Q. In natural world, organisms constantly adapt to their environments in response to challenges and opportunities.

R. This process of adaptation is driven by the principle of natural selection, where favorable traits increase an organism's chances of survival and reproduction.

S. As environments change, organisms that can adapt their behavior, structure and physiology to such changes are more likely to survive.

(A) $\mathrm{P} \rightarrow \mathrm{Q} \rightarrow \mathrm{R} \rightarrow \mathrm{S}$ (B) $\mathrm{Q} \rightarrow \mathrm{S} \rightarrow \mathrm{R} \rightarrow \mathrm{P}$

(C) $\mathrm{R} \rightarrow \mathrm{S} \rightarrow \mathrm{Q} \rightarrow \mathrm{P}$ (D) $\mathrm{S} \rightarrow \mathrm{P} \rightarrow \mathrm{R} \rightarrow \mathrm{Q}$

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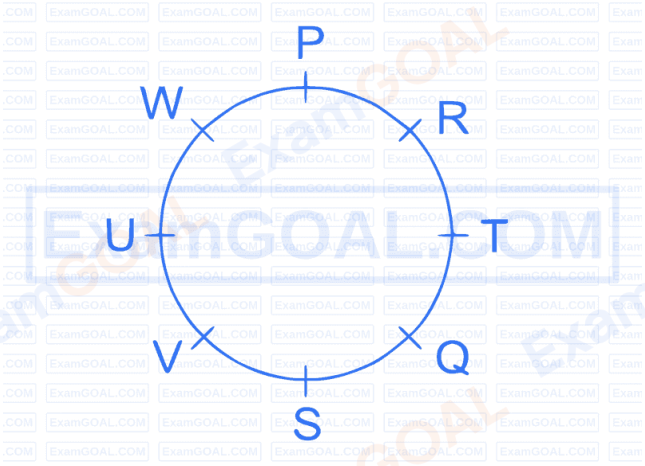
Q40. GATE ECE 2025

Open solution

Eight students (P, Q, R, S, T, U, V, and W) are playing musical chairs. The figure indicates their order of position at the start of the game. They play the game by moving forward in a circle in the clockwise direction.

After the 1st round, 4th student behind P leaves the game. After 2nd round, 5th student behind Q leaves the game. After 3rd round, 3rd student behind V leaves the game. After 4th round, 4th student behind U leaves the game. Who all are left in the game after the 4th round?

Note: The figure shown is representative.



(A) P; T; Q; S (B) V; P; T; Q (C) W; R; Q; V (D) Q; T; V; W

Q41. GATE ECE 2024

Open solution

Sequence the following sentences (P, Q, R, S) in a coherent passage:

P: Shifu's student exclaimed, "Why do you run since the bull is an illusion?"

Q: Shifu said, "Surely my running away from the bull is also an illusion."

R: Shifu once proclaimed that all life is illusion.

S: One day, when a bull gave him chase, Shifu began running for his life.

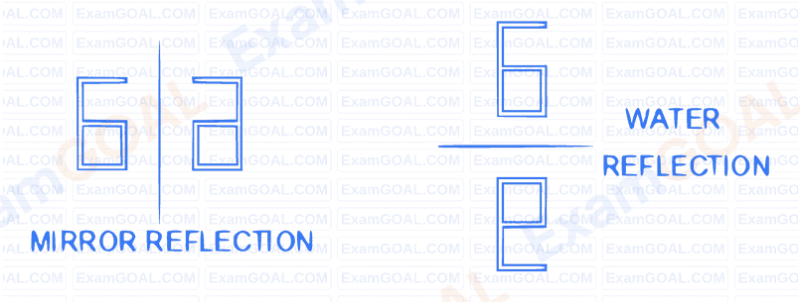
(A) SPRQ (B) SRPQ (C) RSPQ (D) RPQS

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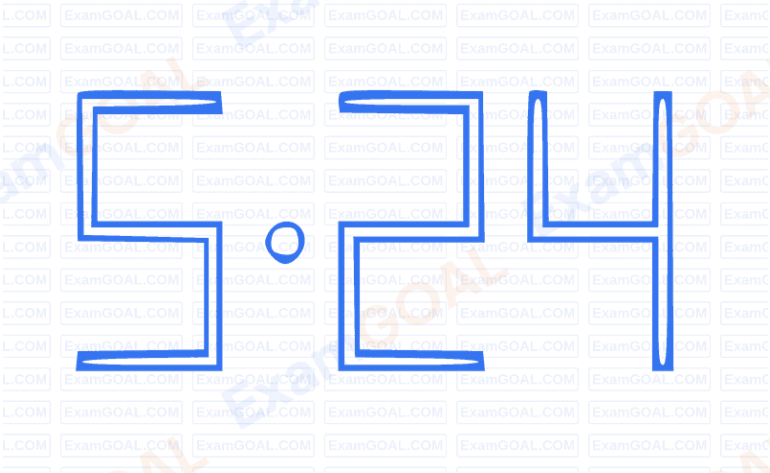
Q42. GATE ECE 2024

Open solution

Examples of mirror and water reflections are shown in the figures below:

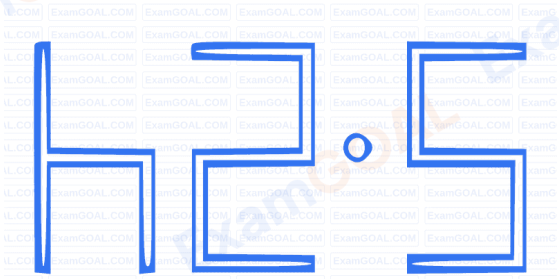


An object appears as the following image after first reflecting in a mirror and then reflecting on water.

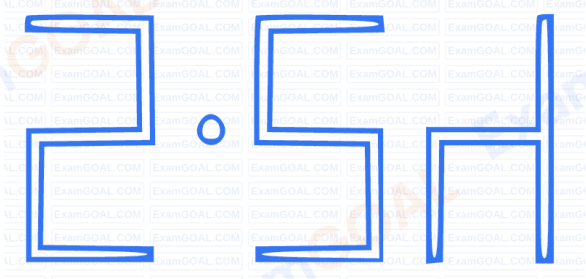


The original object is

(A)

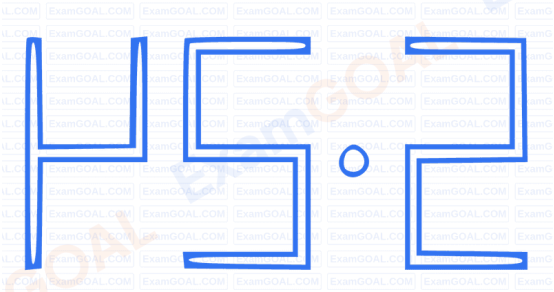


(B)

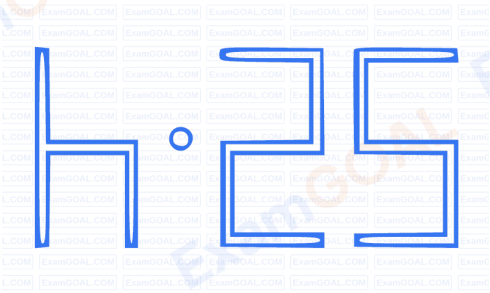


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(C)



(D)



Q43. GATE ECE 2023

Forestland is a planet inhabited by different kinds of creatures. Among other creatures, it is populated by animals all of whom are ferocious. There are also creatures that have claws, and some that do not. All creatures that have claws are ferocious.

Based only on the information provided above, which one of the following options can be logically inferred with certainty?

Open solution

(A) All creatures with claws are animals.

(B) Some creatures with claws are non-ferocious.

(C) Some non-ferocious creatures have claws.

(D) Some ferocious creatures are creatures with claws.

Q44. GATE ECE 2023

Which one of the following options can be inferred from the given passage alone?

When I was a kid, I was partial to stories about other worlds and interplanetary travel. I used to imagine that I could just gaze off into space and be whisked to another planet.

[Excerpt from The Truth about Stories by T. King]

Open solution

(A) It is a child's description of what he or she likes.

(B) It is an adult's memory of what he or she liked as a child.

(C) The child in the passage read stories about interplanetary travel only in parts.

(D) It teaches us that stories are good for children.

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Q45. GATE ECE 2022

Open solution

Mosquitoes pose a threat to human health. Controlling mosquitoes using chemicals may have undesired consequences. In Florida, authorities have used genetically modified mosquitoes to control the overall mosquito population. It remains to be seen if this novel approach has unforeseen consequences.

Which one of the following is the correct logical inference based on the information in the above passage?

(A) Using chemicals to kill mosquitoes is better than using genetically modified mosquitoes because genetic engineering is dangerous.

(B) Using genetically modified mosquitoes is better than using chemicals to kill mosquitoes because they do not have any side effects.

(C) Both using genetically modified mosquitoes and chemicals have undesired consequences and can be dangerous.

(D) Using chemicals to kill mosquitoes may have undesired consequences but it is not clear if using genetically modified mosquitoes has any negative consequences.

Q46. GATE ECE 2021

Open solution

Given below are two statements and two conclusions.

Statement 1 : All purple are green

Statement 2 : All black are green

Conclusion I : Some black are purple.

Conclusion II : No black is purple

Based on the above statements and conclusions, which one of the following options is logically CORRECT?

(A) Both conclusion I and II are correct.

(B) Only conclusion I is correct.

(C) Only conclusion II is correct.

(D) Either conclusion I or II is correct.

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Q47. GATE ECE 2021

Open solution

Computers are ubiquitous. They are used to improve efficiency in almost all fields from agriculture to space exploration. Artificial intelligence (AI) is currently a hot topic AI enables computers to learn, given enough training data. For humans, sitting in front of a computer for long hours can lead to health issues.

Which of the following can be deducted from the above passage?

(i) Nowadays, computers are present in almost all places.

(ii) Computers cannot be used for solving problems in engineering

(iii) For humans, there are both positive and negative effects of using computers.

(iv) Artificial intelligence can be done without data.

(A) (ii) and (iii)
(B) (ii) and (iv)
(C) (i) and (iii)
(D) (i), (iii) and (iv)

Q48. GATE ECE 2019

Open solution

"Indian history was written by British historians – extremely well documented and researched, but not always impartial. History had to serve its purpose : Everything was made subservient to the glory of the Union Jack. Latter-day Indian scholars presented a contrary picture."

From the text above, we can infer that :

Indian history written by British Historians _____.

(A) was not well documented and researched and was sometimes biased
(B) was well documented and not researched but was always biased
(C) was well documented and researched but was sometimes biased
(D) was not well documented and researched and was always biased

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Q49. GATE ECE 2019

Open solution

Four people are standing in a line facing you. They are Rahul, Mathew, Seema and Lohit. One is engineer, one is a doctor, one a teacher and another a dancer. You are told that :

1. Mathew is not standing next to Seema.

2. There are two people standing between Lohit and the engineer.

3. Rahul is not a doctor.

4. The teacher and the dancer are standing next to each other.

5. Seema is turning to her right to speak to the doctor standing next to her.

Who among them is an Engineer ?

(A) Seema (B) Rahul (C) Mathew (D) Lohit

Q50. GATE ECE 2018

Open solution

A coastal region with unparalleled beauty is home to many species of animals. It is dotted with coral reefs and unspoilt white sandy beaches. It has remained inaccessible to tourists due to poor connectivity and lack of accommodation. A company has spotted the opportunity and is planning to develop a luxury resort with helicopter service to the nearest major city airport. Environmentalists are upset that this would lead to the region becoming crowded and polluted like any other major beach resorts.

Which one of the following statements can be logically inferred from the information given in the above paragraph?

(A) The culture and tradition of the local people will be influenced by the tourists.

(B) The region will become crowded and polluted due to tourism.

(C) The coral reefs are on the decline and could soon vanish.

(D) Helicopter connectivity would lead to an increase in tourists coming to the region.

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Q51. GATE ECE 2018

Open solution

The Cricket Board has long recognized John's potential as a leader of the team. However, his on-field temper has always been a matter of concern for them since his junior days. While this aggression has filled stadia with die-hard fans, it has taken a toll on his own batting. Until recently, it appeared that he found it difficult to convert his aggression into big scores. Over the past three seasons though, that picture of John has been replaced by a cerebral, calculative and successful batsman-captain. After many years, it appears that the team has finally found a complete captain.

Which of the following statements can be logically inferred from the above paragraph?

(i) Even as a junior cricketer. John was considered a good captain.

(ii) Finding a complete captain is a challenge.

(iii) Fans and the Cricket Board have differing views on what they want in a captain

(iv) Over the past three seasons John has accumulated big scores.

(A) (ii) and (iv) only
(B) (i), (ii) and (iii) only
(C) (iii) and (iv) only
(D) (i), (ii), (iii) and (iv)

Q52. GATE ECE 2017 Set 2

Open solution

"If you are looking for a history of India, or for an account of the rise and fall of the British Raj, or for the reason of the cleaving of the subcontinent into two mutually antagonistic parts and the effects this mutilation will have in the respective sections, and ultimately on Asia, you will not find it in these pages for though I have spent a lifetime in the country, I lived too near the seat of events, and was too intimately associated with the actors, to get the perspective needed for the impartial recording of these matters."

Which of the following statement best reflects the author's opinion?

(A) An intimate association does not allow for the necessary perspective.
(B) Matters are recorded with an impartial perspective.
(C) An intimate association offers an impartial perspective.
(D) Actors are typically associated with the impartial recording of matters.

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Q53. GATE ECE 2017 Set 1

Open solution

"If you are looking for a history of India, or for an account of the rise and fall of the British Raj, or for the reason of the cleaving of the subcontinent into two mutually antagonistic parts and the effects this mutilation will have in the respective sections, and ultimately on Asia, you will not find it in these pages: for though I have spent a lifetime in the country. I lived too near the seat of events, and was too intimately associated with the actors, to get the perspective needed for the impartial recording of these matters".

Here, the word 'antagonistic' is closest in meaning to

(A) impartial (B) argumentative (C) separated (D) hostile

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Answer Key

Marks 1

1. **B**	2. **A**	3. **D**	4. **A**	5. **C**
6. **A**	7. **C**	8. **C**	9. **B**	10. **B**
11. **A**	12. **C**	13. **A**	14. **A**	15. **A**
16. **A**	17. **C**	18. **C**	19. **D**	20. **A**
21. **A**	22. **C**	23. **A**	24. **A**	25. **A**
26. **A**	27. **D**	28. **B**	29. **B**	30. **C**
31. **B**	32. **D**	33. **D**	34. **B**	35. **A**
36. **D**	37. **C**			

Marks 2

38. **A**	39. **B**	40. *Scan QR*	41. **C**	42. **A**
43. **D**	44. **B**	45. **D**	46. **D**	47. **C**
48. **C**	49. **C**	50. **D**	51. **A**	52. **A**
53. **D**				

For numerical answers given as a range, any value within the range is correct. Full solutions: scan the QR code next to each question, or visit questions.examside.com.

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